THE TIDE REMEMBERS — Complete Story & Game Guide

A complete description of the game's story, world, characters, locations, mechanics, puzzles, horror events and endings, plus how the project is built. Written so that another person or AI can understand the whole game without playing it.

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1. One-paragraph summary

The Tide Remembers is a first-person supernatural horror game (Godot 4.3, no combat) about an **ancient curse on a remote island, where the sea remembers the voices of the people it has taken.** Technician **Elias Vale** is sent at night to **Vey Isle**, removed from the charts in 1972, to restore a dead weather station that has been sending a distress call for six years without power. He finds an empty harbour, a silent village and a lighthouse that should have gone dark. Footsteps follow him and keep walking after he stops. A radio plays his own voice. A drowned voice calls his name from under the dock. In the records of the missing, his name is already written, with a time of death: **03:12**. Something on the island has been waiting for him. He gradually learns, without ever being told everything, that the old villagers feared the sea because it **called them by name**, that researchers in the 1960s disturbed whatever lives beneath the island, and that the lighthouse now calls ships in with the voices of people they love. At the end he must decide what the island says next.

The mystery in five lines: People drowned. Their voices remained. Something beneath the island learned to imitate them. The warning bell was supposed to keep people away. The researchers disturbed it — and now Elias has arrived, and the island is calling again.

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2. The rules of the curse (what the player learns)

1. **The sea remembers.** It keeps the sounds of the people it takes — voices, cries, footsteps, last words — and sometimes gives them back.
2. **Never answer the dead.** Voices that call from the shore, caves or empty rooms are not to be trusted.
3. **The bell is a warning.** When the bell rings by itself, the island is not safe. If it rings **thirteen** times, bar the door. (The square's bell also strikes every in-game hour — Kell's signal.)
4. **Sound attracts the Listener.** It hears ordinary sounds and **pre-echoes** — sounds that arrive before the thing that makes them, the supernatural signature of the curse — and walks to where a sound *will* happen.
5. **White rings offer protection.** An old island custom: the drowned do not cross a white-ringed threshold. The Listener never enters such a room (and never passes a doorway).
6. **Some voices should never be followed.** (This is the heart of Suha's ending.)

Pre-echo examples: Elias's footsteps take three more steps after he stops; a radio announces a conversation he then overhears from another house; the bell rings while hanging still; the lighthouse hatch is heard opening before he pulls the lever; footsteps climb the lighthouse stairs before he moves; his own running footsteps come down a cave gallery toward him.

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3. Backstory (chronological)

When	What happened
Before 1923	Fishermen believe the sea remembers everyone it takes; the dead are heard calling from the shoreline, crewmates from beneath boats. Rule: never answer a voice from the sea after the warning bell rings. White rings are painted on doors.
14 Nov 1923, 02:58	Keeper **Aldo Wren** logs that every sound stopped for **thirteen seconds** — then a bell rang **under the water**.
15 Nov 1923	A tide drowns **Low Vey**, the lower village. Survivors rebuild higher up as **Vey**. Wren keeps the light for the rest of his life.
1968	**Project Pelagic** (lead **Dr. Ruth Marrow**) arrives to study the voices and the sounds that come too early. Research ship **MV Pelagic**. Wren refuses to help.
c. 1970	**Project Morrow**: **Dr. Edwin Morrow**, in an annex beneath the caves, operates on twelve volunteers who hear the voices, to make them hear more clearly. Eleven walk into the sea. **Tomas Kell** — the radio operator, who joined to find missing sailors including his brother — is Subject 12.
1971	Marrow tunes the lighthouse transmitter to the note of the drowned bell and runs it at full power. The thirteen-second silence returns. **Something answers. The Listener appears.** Residents vanish; the voices call everyone by name. The **MV Pelagic** hears a voice calling and sails in; her crew are taken. Boats that come looking are wrecked beside her.
1972	Vey is removed from the charts. Kell has become a bat-like creature roosting by his old radio tower.
Six years ago	The dead weather station starts transmitting a distress call with no power.
Tonight	Elias arrives at 23:40. Morrow's list names **Subject 13: E. VALE — "arrives by sea"**.

The Listener stays mysterious. Wet rope, fishing net, mineral shards and old ship parts; an iron cage for a head. Village stories describe something like it long before the researchers. The player can wonder whether it is a guardian of the drowned, something living beneath the island, a creature formed from the missing, or an ancient presence that imitates voices. Marrow's last note: "It was here before Low Vey drowned. Before the village. We only gave it a louder voice."

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4. Characters (simple motivations)

Character	Motivation / role
Elias Vale	The player; technician sent to restore the station. Speaks sparingly (subtitles only, not voiced).
Aldo Wren	Keeper who witnessed 1923; kept the light and the old customs; wrote the warnings.
Dr. Ruth Marrow	Wanted to understand the voices; grew frightened; tuned the light to the drowned bell and woke what answered.
Dr. Edwin Morrow	Professional and cold; tried to make people hear the island; destroyed them.
Ines & Nell Halloran	Mother and daughter. Ines heard her name and went to the water; she told Nell never to open the door, "not even if they sound like me".

Character	Motivation / role
Tomas Kell	Radio operator who joined to find his missing brother; heard a voice like his own; became the creature in Blackwood. Left his diary and his last recording.
Suha	Elias's love on the mainland. Optional and secondary: two ordinary, personal radio calls, then a final call asking him to come to the top of the lighthouse. The island learned her voice from his memory.
The Listener	The main threat (see above).
The Lodger / the drowned	If Elias stands still, something whispers in his ear from behind. Drowned figures stand only where he isn't looking.

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5. The world: locations in play order

Main path is marked **(M)**; optional chapters **(O)**. Chapter title cards appear on first arrival.

I. The Flooded Dock (M)

Arrival by maintenance boat. The boat radio plays Elias's own voice ("Mainland, this is Vale. I'm on the dock. There's nobody here."), then Suha's first call. Stepping onto the dock, footsteps follow him and take three more steps after he stops. The maintenance shed (white ring = safe) holds the **field recorder**, the dock log and the work order. Tutorial: Listen [Q] reveals the footsteps again with his own whispered voice beneath ("...don't let it hear you twice..."); Record [R + LMB] captures it. The boat is also where every ending's final scene plays.

II. The Abandoned Settlement (M)

Lit windows with no power; tea still warm; a chair turned to face the wall. Houses: the **teahouse** (radio announces a conversation about the station key; moments later the same conversation is heard from the blue house), the **blue house** (white ring; Nell's bed; Ines's letter; the **backwards clock** holding the **station key**), the **harbourmaster's office** (Marrow's note on replay echoes; the map of red pins), a collapsed house. A bell in the square — it rings while motionless, and **it strikes every in-game hour** (Kell's signal). The first glimpse of the Listener: standing under a lamp on the lighthouse road, gone when the lamp blinks. After the key is taken, the Listener arrives and patrols the settlement. A stone wall with a chained gate closes the lighthouse road until the endings.

III. The Weather Station (M)

Fenced compound (key opens the gate). Restore power: open the **fuel valve**, then pull the generator cord. Lights return; Suha calls again on the station radio. The office tape deck (white ring) plays **Calibration Tape 13** — only hiss, unless you **listen**: then you hear footsteps on metal and four tones: MIDDLE, LOW, HIGH, LOW. Those are *Elias's own future footsteps* between the relays. The equipment corridor's three relays (A low, B middle, C high) must be engaged in that order (**B, A, C, A**). A wrong press trips the breaker (blackout, the Listener comes toward the station) and resets — never a soft-lock. Then transmit the diagnostic report from the monitoring room: the radio answers in Elias's voice ("Don't go into the caves... It heard you coming") and **the tide pulls away from the island**, exposing the tidal shelf, the caves and Low Vey.

IV. Blackwood Forest + the Old Radio Tower (O)

Pine woods west of the settlement. Net-wrapped remains hang in the trees; Listener silhouettes stand between trunks and vanish when looked at. A notice: no one in the woods when the bell strikes the hour; if you hear clicking above you, do not move. **Kell's hut** at the base of the old radio tower (white ring) holds his two diary pages, his radio rig ("IT TALKS BACK"), a blacked-out mirror ("I DON'T LOOK LIKE ME"), tally marks counting hours, and the **floodlight switch** for the tower. North-west, a rock outcrop leads down into **the Roost**: Kell hangs asleep from the ceiling above his nest of gull bones, rope and radio valves. Noise wakes him (first a stir, then he wakes). **Taking Kell's tape** from the nest (last recording 3/3) wakes him for a chase; the only way to end it is to throw the tower floodlight, which burns him out of the sky. In the light he looks like a man again.

Kell's hourly hunt (any time he is alive): the island clock runs from 23:40 (one in-game hour every ten real minutes; press **T** for the watch). When the bell strikes, Kell leaves the roost and hunts Blackwood for ten in-game minutes. Every few seconds his sonar clicks sweep the woods; if you are **moving in the open** when a sweep passes over you, he screeches and dives. Survive by **standing still**, getting **under a roof**, or catching him in your **flashlight** (stuns him).

V. The Ship Graveyard (O)

West shore below Blackwood. The research ship **MV Pelagic** lies on her side; the boats that came looking for her are wrecked in the shallows; drowned crew stand in the surf. Inside the cargo hold: a net full of crew with their ears cut away, blood on the walls, the ship's radio log ("03:09 Crew below. Ears bleeding. Morrow's people are collecting"). Approaching the radio: it switches itself on, screams (a jumpscare), then repeats the Pelagic's **mayday** ("we hear the island answering... it is asking us to come closer"), which can be recorded (last recording 2/3).

VI. Low Vey — the submerged village (O, low tide only)

The village drowned in 1923 lies on the tidal shelf below the east cliffs, exposed only after the station transmission. Roofless cottages, a fallen church bell, a family at supper with their heads all turned toward the lighthouse, the keeper's 1923 log. Walking into the square triggers **the thirteen-second silence**: all sound stops; when it returns, seven drowned figures stand in a ring around Elias, then are gone. Low Vey sits beside the clear lane leading to the cave mouth.

VII. The Tidal Caves (M)

Reached at the end of the exposed shelf. A survey cable with yellow tags guides the way. Pre-echo splashes in still pools; footsteps from inside the rock. **Puzzle:** an iron resonance seal opens only to the "tide bell" — a drowned ship's bell in a side niche that is motionless but rings when you **listen**. Record it and **replay it into the seal's horn**. Beyond, the long gallery is patrolled by the Listener; a loose plate in a side cave bangs "when the sea breathes" — record it and replay it to send the Listener away (replayed sounds return to where they were recorded). An iron stair at the far end climbs into the lighthouse.

VIII. The Underground Research Annex — Project Morrow (O)

Through an iron door marked MORROW in the cave gallery. Flickering clinical corridor; the Listener glimpsed at its far end. **Examination room**: a dental-style chair with a headset bolted into the skull of whoever sat there, covered bodies, jars of human ears labelled by date (some dates next year). **Containment cells**: a body grown into rope and netting. **Records office** (white ring): Morrow's clinical summary and the subject list naming **Subject 13:**

E. Vale. **Morrow's tape** (last recording 1/3): taking it kills the lights and the Listener comes down the corridor — a chase to the ringed office or the ladder.

IX. The Lighthouse (M)

Entered from below through a grate. Walkable tower: ground floor (barred front door, sealed hatch), maintenance landing (+6 m) with a tape in Elias's voice ("Send it... don't trust the tape upstairs"), control room (+12 m) with a contradicting tape ("Don't listen to the other tape") and the **seal release lever**. Approaching the lever, Elias hears the hatch far below grind open *before* he pulls it; pulling it is silent. On the stairs, the Listener is glimpsed on the landing above. The beacon outside stops turning when you look straight at it. After the transmitter is armed, an iron ladder to the **lantern room** becomes usable (Suha's ending).

X. The Transmitter Chamber — "What the Tide Remembers" (M)

A circular hall beneath the lighthouse; the transmitter (coils, copper rings, glowing tubes) in the centre; the Listener patrols around it. Three power **couplings** on the walls: each one **clanks before you touch it** (pre-echo) and the Listener walks to that sound — let it look, hide behind pillars, then pull. A valve that hammers can be recorded and replayed as a lure. With all three engaged, the Listener stops and turns its head toward Elias: it is listening for the choice. Marrow's final note lies on the console. Then the choice.

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6. The endings (four)

All endings finish with the boat scene at the dock (except The Light), then an ending card.

1. **BREAK THE SIGNAL** — pull the red lever (OVERLOAD). Flash, the Listener collapses into a heap of rope, real silence; the tide returns. Walking back, Elias's footsteps happen exactly when he takes them. On the boat the radio whispers one last faint pre-echo: "...three more steps." Card: the island went silent; eleven days later a fishing boat hears footsteps on an empty dock.
2. **SEND THE WARNING** — turn the key (TRANSMIT). The mainland copies; every radio on the island answers in Elias's voice; the Listener turns away into the dark; the beacon burns brighter. On the boat the radio says his next words before he speaks them: "—it's on the boat." Card: a storm and a ferry were saved; the signal spread along the coast.
3. **THE LAST RECORDING** (secret) — only if Elias carries all three optional recordings (Morrow's tape, the Pelagic mayday, Kell's tape). A third option appears: play them into the transmitter. It "hears itself"; the Listener walks to it and collapses; the thirteen seconds play back to the machine. On the boat his recorder holds one file, thirteen seconds long. Card: ordinary silence at last.
4. **THE LIGHT (SUHA)** — after the transmitter is armed, Suha calls one last time: "None of this is real. You fell asleep on the boat. Come up to the top of the lighthouse — to the light. I'll wake you up." If Elias climbs the ladder to the lantern room instead of choosing at the console, he finds her there, her back to him, in a pale dress. She says she knew he'd come. She turns: a drowned face. The island, in her voice: "There was never anyone waiting for you, Elias. You drowned at 03:12. We only needed someone to keep the light." Card: ships still pick up a calm man on 2.182 MHz asking Suha to come up to the light. Theme: love used as a lure; betrayal.

Suha is kept secondary: an ordinary call when Elias lands (his scarf), another at the station (a memory of a ferry), and the final call after the transmitter is armed. Her voice is soft and dreamy; Elias's thoughts are text only.

7. Mechanics (how the game plays)

Controls: WASD move · mouse look · Shift sprint (loud) · Ctrl crouch (quiet, harder to see) · Space jump · E interact/read · F flashlight · Q recorder listen · R recorder panel · LMB record/replay · wheel/Tab select recording · J journal · T watch · Esc pause · F11/Alt+Enter fullscreen.

The field recorder - *Listen (Q)*: ambience is filtered; a hidden audio layer opens (pre-echoes, the calibration tape tones, the drowned bell, the whispering under the dock footsteps). Movement is slower while listening. - *Record*: hold near a recordable sound for 2.4 s; some only exist while listening. - *Replay*: the recorder's small speaker plays the sound where Elias stands (quiet, but the Listener can hear it), then **the island returns the sound, loudly, to the place it was recorded** — the main way to lure the Listener. Replaying into a device (the seal's horn) can also solve puzzles.

Noise & stealth. Every footstep emits a noise radius: crouching ≈1.5 m, walking ≈5 m, sprinting ≈16 m; water and metal floors are louder. Doors, machines, jumping, the flashlight click, replay and pre-echoes also emit noise. Safe places are communicated by a painted **white ring** on the door.

The Listener (AI). States: Dormant, Roaming (patrol points), Investigating (walks to a heard sound, head turns first), Searching (silent, looks around ~9 s), Hunting (chases while it sees you; gives up after losing sight ~4.5 s or after ~22 s), Returning. It sees ~10 m in a 70° cone from its head (×0.45 crouched, ×1.6 with the flashlight on). It never paths through doorways and backs out of ringed rooms. Catching Elias triggers a short death sequence and a reload at the last checkpoint.

Kell (boss). Hourly emergence via the in-game clock and the settlement bell; sonar sweeps every few seconds; detection only if moving in the open within range; screech → dive (~1.3 s warning); flashlight in his face stuns him; the radio-tower floodlight kills him during the chase.

Horror systems. The Lodger (stand still ~25 s → breathing approaches from behind → a whisper in the ear; turning round in time shows a face); apparitions that exist only out of view; first-entry house scares (the chair that becomes occupied in the teahouse, the harbourmaster's door slamming and lights dying, a face at the blue house window, a figure at the station window); Listener glimpses; the thirteen-second silence; jumpscare stings used sparingly. Curse set-pieces: a drowned voice calls Elias's name from under the dock; a child knocks from inside the empty wardrobe in Nell's room; in Wren's office mirror a drowned figure stands behind Elias but not in the room (a real mirror camera with a ghost layer only it can see); footsteps climb the lighthouse stairs before he moves; after Low Vey's silence the bell rings under the sea; at 03:00 the bell strikes thirteen; missing-person notices and an abandoned shelter in Blackwood; a deckhand's bunk and unsent letter on the Pelagic; a cave wall of names of everyone who followed a voice inside — the newest is E. VALE.

Story delivery. Opening briefing cards; ten chapter title cards; **Elias's journal [J]** that fills in plain language as he learns things (why he is here, pre-echoes, the recorder, the Listener, the key, Pelagic, the tide, Low Vey, Morrow, Kell, the missing ships, the last recording, Suha, what is happening, the choice); Elias's thoughts (subtitles) at key moments; examine points with his comments; documents (notes, logs, letters, diaries) read in a paper overlay; radio and tape scenes, all **voiced** and subtitled.

Checkpoints & saving. Progress (flags, objective, recordings, journal, clock) saves automatically at checkpoints; Continue on the main menu. Death reloads the last checkpoint.

Sound. Zone-based ambience (sea, wind, interior, caves, woods, drone, the lighthouse signal), rain with occasional thunder, a distant foghorn, surface-aware heel-and-toe footsteps, spatial 3D audio, separate buses for ambience, effects, pre-echoes, voices and the listen-only layer. Speech is generated offline with Kokoro TTS (Suha in a soft, dreamy voice; radio and tape voices) and always subtitled; Elias's own thoughts are text-only; captions for sound effects are optional.

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8. Puzzles (complete list and solutions)

#	Where	Puzzle	Solution
1	Dock shed	Recorder tutorial	Take the recorder, listen (Q), record the footsteps.
2	Settlement	Station key	The teahouse radio says the key is with "the only thing in Vey that keeps time"; the conversation repeats from the blue house: open the backwards clock.
3	Station	Power	Open the fuel valve, then pull the starter cord (without fuel it coughs and dies).
4	Station	Relay order	Listen at Tape 13 in the office: MIDDLE, LOW, HIGH, LOW → relays **B, A, C, A**. Wrong order = blackout + reset.
5	Station	Transmit	Use the monitoring console → tide goes out.
6	Caves	Resonance seal	Listen at the drowned bell, record it, replay it near the seal's horn.
7	Caves	Gallery	Sneak past the Listener, or record the loose plate and replay it to lure it away.
8	Lighthouse	Lower seal	Climb to the control room; pull the seal release; descend through the hatch.
9	Chamber	Couplings	Engage all three couplings while avoiding the Listener (each pre-echoes; lure it with the valve recording).
—	Optional	Last recording	Morrow's tape (annex), the Pelagic mayday (ship graveyard radio), Kell's tape (the Roost) — no extra puzzle.

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9. Timeline of a typical playthrough

23:40 arrival → dock and recorder → settlement and key (Listener begins patrolling) → station power, tape, relays, transmission (tide out) → optional: Blackwood/Kell, ship graveyard, Low Vey → caves and seal → optional annex → lighthouse → chamber → choice at about 03:12 story-time → boat → ending card. Length: roughly 60–90 minutes with optional content.

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10. Art & tone

Cinematic low-poly realism with weathered materials; restrained palette (blue-grey sea, cold green grass, wet charcoal stone, faded wood, amber practical lights, occasional red warning lamps); heavy but selective fog; rain; practical lights (flashlight, lamps, lit windows, the lighthouse beacon). Horror comes mostly from sound, absence and rules the player learns, with a few memorable scares and a small number of deliberate body-horror scenes (Morrow's annex, the Pelagic hold, Blackwood remains, Low Vey's supper, Kell's nest). No combat; no gore for its own sake.

11. How the project is built (for developers)

- Engine: **Godot 4.3**, GDScript, Forward+ (Compatibility fallback works). The whole island is assembled from code at load (~3 s): `scenes/island.tscn → scripts/world/island.gd`.
- Autoloads: `Game` (state, flags, objectives, saves, settings, input map, clock, journal, fullscreen) and `Sound` (bus layout, ambience zones, positional sounds, pre-echo, noise events, voice lines).
- Areas, one script each in `scripts/world/areas/`: dock, settlement, station, caves, lighthouse, chamber, forest (Blackwood + radio tower + roost), graveyard, lowvey, annex. Shared systems: `horror.gd`, `immersion.gd`, `zone.gd`, `door.gd`, `interactable.gd`, `recordable.gd`, `build.gd` (geometry helpers), `props.gd`, `models.gd` (GLB loader), `terrain.gd`, `ocean.gd` (tide).
- Enemies: `scripts/enemy/listener.gd` (+ procedural model), `kell.gd` (+ Blender model).
- All text lives in `scripts/data/story.gd`: objectives, chapters, journal, Elias lines, examine comments, documents, radio/tape sequences, recordings.
- Assets: procedural textures (`tools/gen_textures.py`), procedural SFX (`tools/gen_audio.py`), Blender models (`tools/blender/build_models.py`, run with the `bpy` package), voices (`tools/export_lines.gd` + `tools/gen_voice.py`, Kokoro TTS).
- Tests: `tests/run_all.sh` runs scripted scenarios (full playthroughs for every ending, walking routes, AI, death, menus, optional chapters, Kell, horror, voices).
- Builds: `release/TheTideRemembers-windows.zip` (Windows export).